the possibility that we would both use our competencies in technology and scientific skills. So we can go one step further, and maybe we might have new developments in future, including in aviation.

Q. So France is open to a lot of joint developments with India, and cooperate in any matter that is useful to us?
A. Absolutely. I think our record vis-à-vis India has been most open in terms of cooperation, including in sensitive issues, and in terms of technology transfers. So we can build on that.

Q. India and France have both been victims of terror. Both PM Modi and the President of France have announced that we will cooperate on terror and counterterrorism. What can India and France do to help things along?
A. We can do a lot. Because we understand the suffering of people of our countries who have been attacked by terrorism. We do share information, including intelligence. And on the international scene, we promote the new addition of 'No Money for Terror'. The first conference was held in Paris, at the OECD [Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development]. I was the ambassador to the OECD then. And we are building on this to take new steps and embark with other countries on that fight against terror. Counter-intelligence is sometimes necessary, but sharing of information about the money used to fund terror, where it comes from and where it goes, is a very useful tool. So we will work together on that.

Q. There have been media reports that France and India are jointly co-sponsoring resolutions of the UN Security Council to designate global terrorists, particularly those who have attacked our countries. How advanced is that move and do you see that happening a lot more?
A. It will take some time to consult and make progress. But I think that any nation or any group can be subjected to a terrorist attack. So it is not something just for India or France or, say, Europe or the western world. It is a concern every single nation should share. So we do have to promote that and to build a few bridges, wherever they are necessary.

Q. So it is not just 'no money for terror' but also 'no tolerance for terrorists', and you will ensure that these people are globally designated as terrorists, wherever necessary.
A. And no place for hate speeches. Next week, at the UN General Assembly in New York, President Macron will be there, and he will be with the prime minister of New Zealand to launch, or renew, the Christchurch Appeal, that is, fighting terror and hate speeches online. This is another powerful instrument. So there will be a new momentum given next week for counterterrorism and fighting hate speech online.

Q. The other area discussed during your visit here is the Indo-Pacific and the threats the region faces, particularly from a belligerent China. What measures can India and France take to ensure greater peace and security in the region?
A. I have to remind everyone that we, the French, are a resident people in the Indo-Pacific, West Indo-Pacific and in the Indian Ocean. We are a Pacific nation. We do a lot already. The strategic partnership that we have forged for 25 years has security and defence dimensions as well as industrial cooperation, but it also has an operational pillar to it. We do joint patrols in the Indian Ocean, for example. Today, we discussed these issues and we believe that there is room for deeper cooperation between India and France vis-a-vis some countries that might be subject to action from other countries, and I would not name only China. We are keen to keep doing what we have done and promote peace and stability in the region. This applies to the Indian Ocean, and to some African states. But there is also potential to do it in the Pacific area by, for example, identifying development projects that can be useful to smaller states, and by acting together. Not competing, but combining our forces.



"India and France share intelligence on terrorism. Exchanging information about money used to fund terror is important. We will work on it"